NASA's Big Plan: Build a Moon Base by 2032

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NASA has big plans for the Moon. On Saturday, November 7, it said it will spend up to $10 billion to build a lasting moon base for astronauts by 2032.

The biggest part is a new plan called **CLPS 2**, worth up to $10 billion over ten years. NASA picked eight companies to take part, including Blue Origin, SpaceX and Lockheed Martin. NASA also raised the limit of its first CLPS deal from $2.6 billion to $4.2 billion.

NASA leader Jared Isaacman said the old deal worked for one or two trips a year. Doing more needs room to move things around.

The plan also has a robot **rover** called PROMISE. It runs on **nuclear power** and will explore the Moon's **south pole** from late 2028, using a drill to look for **water ice**. NASA gave Blue Origin $94 million to carry it to the Moon.

NASA also gave about $1.3 billion in launch work to other companies. All of this is part of NASA's Phase One plan, which runs through 2029. Phase Two, from 2029 to 2032, will keep building the base.

Word Treasure

CLPS 2 -- CLPS 2 is NASA's new plan to send things to the Moon.

rover -- A rover is a robot vehicle that explores the surface of the Moon.

nuclear power -- Nuclear power is a strong kind of energy made inside tiny parts of atoms.

water ice -- Water ice is frozen water found on the Moon.

south pole -- The south pole is the far southern end of the Moon.

Background you need

NASA is the group that sends astronauts and robots into space to explore.

A moon base is a place on the Moon where astronauts can live and work for a long time.

NASA is working with companies that build rockets and landers, and a robot rover will search for water ice at the Moon's south pole.

Break it down

WHO: NASA, its leader Jared Isaacman, and eight companies including Blue Origin, SpaceX and Lockheed Martin

WHAT: A plan to build a lasting moon base for astronauts, with a robot rover searching for water ice

WHERE: On the Moon, at its south pole

WHY: To give astronauts a lasting home on the Moon, with more trips and room to move things around

Why it matters

A moon base could one day let astronauts live and work on the Moon, and the rockets and robots built for it are the same kind of science you might study in class or see in a museum.

Test what you remember

1. How much will NASA spend to build a lasting moon base?

- (A) Up to $10 billion
- (B) Up to $1.3 billion
- (C) Up to $2.6 billion
- (D) Up to $94 million

2. What is CLPS 2?

- (A) A kind of rocket fuel
- (B) NASA's new plan, worth up to $10 billion over ten years
- (C) The name of the moon base
- (D) A robot rover

3. Which companies were picked to take part in CLPS 2?

- (A) Blue Origin, SpaceX and Lockheed Martin, among eight companies
- (B) Only Blue Origin
- (C) Only Lockheed Martin
- (D) Only SpaceX

4. What will the robot rover PROMISE do?

- (A) Explore the Moon's south pole and use a drill to look for water ice
- (B) Carry astronauts to the Moon
- (C) Fly back to Earth with Moon rocks
- (D) Build the moon base by itself

5. What kind of power does PROMISE run on?

- (A) Wind power
- (B) Batteries that never run out
- (C) Nuclear power
- (D) Sunlight only

6. When will Phase Two keep building the base?

- (A) Before 2028
- (B) From 2028 to 2029
- (C) After 2035
- (D) From 2029 to 2032

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: A 4: A 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. NASA leader Jared Isaacman: He said the old deal worked for one or two trips a year, and doing more needs room to move things around.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):